

STUDY GROUP FINDER

CSE3311 inception presentation

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PROJECT OVERVIEW/VISION

Study Group Finder is a web application designed to help college students easily find and connect with other students who want to study for the same courses. Students can create study groups, search for existing groups, join groups that match their needs, and organize meeting details such as time and location. Our goal is to make finding study partners easier, faster, and more organized.

CUSTOMERS & USERS

Customers:

- Universities and colleges that want to encourage student collaboration and academic success

Target Users:

- College and university students
- Students enrolled in same course
- students looking for study partners or group study sessions

Problems We Solve:

- Difficult to find classmates studying the same course
- Study groups are often unorganized and spread across different platforms
- Students need an easier way to connect and schedule study sessions

USER FEEDBACK & COLLABORATION

How we'll gather feedback:

- Collect feedback from classmates and fellow UTA students
- Test new features with students throughout development
- Gather suggestions through surveys and informal interviews

Continuous Improvement:

- Improve the application based on user feedback
- Fix usability issues and refine features
- Ensure the app meets students' real study need

Why This Matters:

- Direct access to representative users
- Helps build a more useful and user-friendly application

CORE FEATURES

Study Group Finder is built around four features that solve the problems we identified: students cannot find classmates in their course, groups are scattered across platforms, and group info goes stale. Each feature maps to one of those problems.

Create a group:

Post course, time, location, and a max size.
Early iterations

Search and filter

Find groups by course, day, time, and location.
Early iterations

Join with limits

One click to join. Blocked once the group is full.
Early iterations

Status and editing:

Open, Full, Completed, or Cancelled. Owners can edit.
Middle iterations

USER STORIES / USE CASES

User stories

As a student, I want to:

- Search groups by course, time, and location so I can find one that fits my schedule
- See the member count before joining so I know there is room
- See the meeting time and location so I know where to show up

As a group creator, I want to:

- Set a course, time, location, and max size so the right classmates find my group and it does not get overcrowded
- Edit details and set the status to Open, Full, Completed, or Cancelled so nobody shows up to a group that stopped meeting

Use case: join a study group

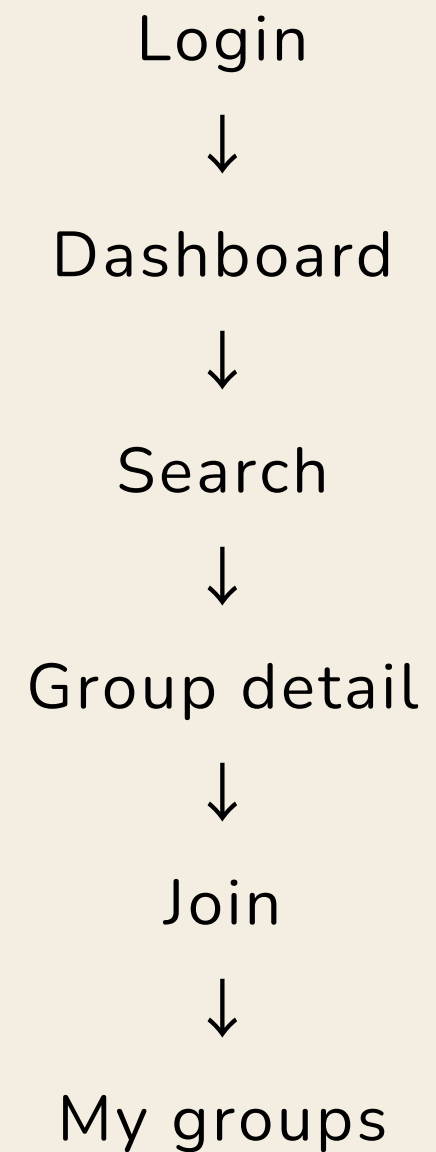
Starts when a logged in student wants to find a group for one of their courses.

1. Student searches by course, time, or location
2. System shows matching groups that are still open
3. Student opens a group to see the meeting time, location, and seats left
4. Student clicks Join
5. System checks capacity and adds the student
6. The group appears under My Groups

If the group filled up first, the system rejects the request and marks it Full.

SCREEN DESIGN/ FLOW

Student flow

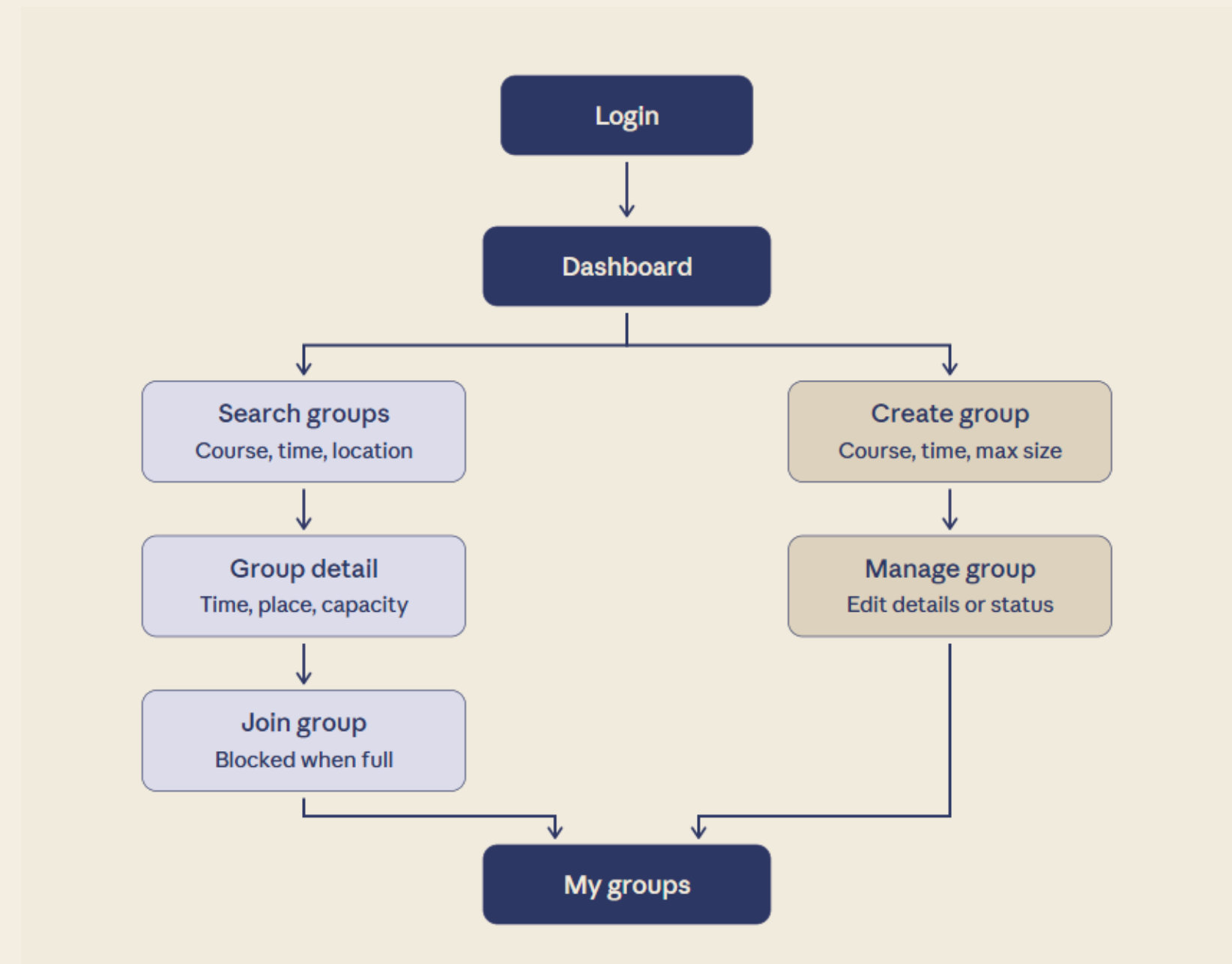


Screens:

Search and browse:
Filters for course, time, and location.
Results as a card list.

Group detail and join:
Meeting details, members against
capacity, join button.

Create and manage:
Required fields, capacity limit, owner
status controls.



COMPETITORS

Meetup

Website + Mobile App

What it is: Social platform for organizing in-person and virtual gatherings around shared interests. 60M+ users worldwide.¹

How it works: Users register, build a profile, then join or create a group. Members RSVP to individual events.²

Key features: RSVP tracking, Discussion boards, Recurring events, Web + iOS/Android

Discord

Website + Desktop + Mobile App

What it is: A communication platform built around invite-based servers. Discord's own docs list study groups as a use case.³

How it works: Students join or create a server, then use text and voice channels to coordinate.³

Key features: Real-time voice/video, Text + voice channels, Screen sharing, Cross-platform

Nylo: Peer Learning

Mobile App Only

What it is: Mobile app built specifically for college students to find study groups and peer tutors.⁴

How it works: Students browse groups filtered by course, join, and request tutoring from peers.⁴

Key features: Course-based filtering, Peer tutoring, Shared notes, iPhone/iPad only

HOW DO WE DIFFER FROM COMPETITORS

	Meetup	Discord	Nylo	Study Group Finder
Platform	Web + mobile	Web + desktop + mobile	Mobile only (iOS)	Web (any device)
Course-based matching	No	No	Yes	Yes
Shows meeting time/ location before joining	Partial	No	Yes	Yes
Capacity limit enforced	No	No	No	Yes
Group status tracking (Open/Full/etc.)	No	No	No	Yes

Meetup has no course field or capacity cap. Discord shows nothing about a group before you join. Nylo is iOS-only with no status system. Study Group Finder is the only option built specifically around course-based matching, upfront meeting details, and enforced capacity and status tracking.

PROJECT RISKS

We identified and prioritized the risks that could have the greatest impact on the core functionality and usability of our Study Group Finder.

Priority	Risk	probability	impact	Risk exposure
1	scheduling & Availability conflict	high	high	high
2	Group capacity conflicts	medium	high	high
3	inactive or outdated study groups	high	medium	medium- high
4	inaccurate or duplicate group information	medium	medium	medium

Risks are ordered from highest to lowest exposure based on their probability and potential impact on the project.

RISK-BASED IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

Risk	how we will address it	when
scheduling & availability conflicts	Allow students to specify meeting times and use time/availability filters when searching for groups.	Early iterations
Group capacity conflicts	Enforce maximum group capacity and prevent additional users from joining once a group is full.	Early iterations
Inactive/ outdated groups	Add group statuses such as Open, Full, Completed, and Cancelled so outdated groups can be closed.	middle iterations
inaccurate/ duplicate info	Use required fields and input validation and allow group creators to edit incorrect information	middle iterations

Risk-Based Strategy: High-exposure risks affecting core functionality will be implemented and tested first.

REPOSITORY & VERSION

The team's GitHub repository hosts our version-controlled files and gives the professor and TA visibility into our progress. Because most current work happens in Google Docs and Slides, the repository points to those documents instead of duplicating them.

Repository created, all team members added as collaborators

Professor and TA given read access

Folders organized for documents, presentations, designs, and code

Changelog tracks the current version number: CHANGELOG.md

Repository link: <https://github.com/buildwithsaalem/StudyMore/>

Current version: v.01

THANK YOU